

Seven questions before I build it.

Premier Detailing · Stratford ON · v1 = 3-min end-of-day session, v2 = autonomous (Square + bank + Wagepoint). Answer these and the build is deterministic — every one of them locks a structural decision I can't easily reverse later.

QUESTION 01

Lock the chart of accounts — what's the complete list, and is it closed?

Revenue lines

You named six: Square deposit, Square final payment, cash, e-transfer, tips, refunds. Anything missing — gift cards, account credits, chargebacks, package pre-pays, referral kickbacks?

Service tiers (for per-tier margin)

Interior, Exterior, Premier, Ceramic — are those four the locked set, or do you also need a Maintenance/Recurring tier and an Add-on tier (headlight restoration, pet hair, engine bay)?

Cost categories

Eight you named: chemicals, equipment, fuel, payroll, software, marketing, fees, taxes. Missing candidates: vehicle insurance, vehicle maintenance, bank/loan interest, professional fees (accountant, lawyer), training/courses, uniforms, packaging, phone/internet. Which belong in v1?

Supplier list

PDS, Auto Obsessed, TOC, CT, Amazon — closed list with an Other bucket, or open-ended where new suppliers auto-create?

Default I'd ship: closed list, an explicit "unlock" gesture to add a category mid-season so the books don't sprawl. Confirm or override.

QUESTION 02

What is the canonical Job ID, and how does the inventory tool hand off chemical cost-per-job?

Per-job profitability is the headline metric. It only works if the bookkeeping agent and the inventory tool agree on what a "job" is.

Job identifier — pick one

(a) Square invoice number · (b) your own internal job number · (c) customer + service date · (d) VIN or licence plate.

Hand-off mechanism

Does the inventory tool write to a shared file (CSV/JSON/SQLite), a Google Sheet, an API, or do I scrape an export? What's the cadence — real-time, end-of-day batch, on-demand pull?

Without a stable join key, every per-job number in the tool is a guess. This is the spine.

QUESTION 03

HST: Regular method or Quick Method, and how do you want it captured?

Method

Regular (track ITCs line-by-line, claim back HST paid on every qualifying expense) or Quick Method (remit a flat ~8.8% on HST-included revenue, no ITCs except on capital purchases)? At your revenue band the Quick Method often wins for service businesses — but it changes how the agent records every expense.

Capture style

Manual HST entry per transaction, or auto-derive from category (fuel → 13%, payroll → 0%, Amazon → prompt because it's mixed, US suppliers → 0% with self-assessment flag)?

Filing cadence

Quarterly or annual remittance? Drives whether the dashboard shows a 90-day or 365-day HST-owed running total.

QUESTION 04

Where do the books live, and how do receipt photos attach?

Storage substrate

(a) local SQLite file on your laptop · (b) Google Sheet you can open from the truck · (c) Airtable · (d) Notion DB · (e) something self-hosted. This decision is near-irreversible — it dictates how v2's Square API + bank feed write in.

Receipts

Photos stored where (Google Drive folder, iCloud, embedded blob in DB) and linked to a transaction by what (filename = transaction ID, OCR scrape of total + date, or you tag at upload)?

Backup + export

Tax-time export format — CSV for your accountant, QBO/Wave import, or PDF year-end pack?
Backup cadence?

QUESTION 05

Anomaly thresholds — pick the actual numbers.

"Alerts when category spend trips a threshold or revenue dips off pace" needs concrete numbers, otherwise the agent stays silent or cries wolf.

Revenue pace

If target = \$135K mid-point over a ~7-month season (Apr–Oct), that's roughly \$640/operating day. What % below pace, sustained for how many days, fires the alert? (Default I'd ship: rolling 7-day actual vs 7-day target, alert at –25%.)

Category spend

Hard monthly \$ cap per category (chemicals > \$800/mo) or rolling 4-week deviation > X% from baseline? Mix of both?

Per-job margin floor

Below what margin does a job get flagged for review — 40%, 50%? Same floor across all four service tiers, or different per tier?

Cash position

Minimum cash-on-hand alert level (e.g., operating account < \$5K)?

QUESTION 06

Mileage and labor — how are they allocated to jobs?

Mileage

(a) you log per-job km at end-of-day (cleanest for CRA, more input) · (b) odometer start & end of day, agent pro-rates km across jobs by count or by revenue · (c) Google Maps timeline / vehicle GPS pull. Personal vs business split — is the truck 100% business?

Labor

Solo operator, or employees on Wagepoint? If solo: what internal hourly rate does the tool book against your time so per-job margin is honest? If employees: hours-per-job entered, or allocated proportionally?

If labor isn't in the per-job formula, "profitability" is really just gross margin. Worth being explicit.

QUESTION 07

End-of-day session shape — what does the 3-minute flow actually look like?

Input model — pick one

(a) **Daily totals only** — "today: \$620 revenue across 3 jobs, \$45 fuel, \$80 chemicals." Fastest, lowest fidelity. · (b) **Transaction-by-transaction with smart defaults** — agent pre-fills category, HST, supplier from patterns, you confirm. · (c) **Photo-first** — snap receipts + drop Square export, agent extracts and only asks on ambiguity.

Hard out at 5 minutes

If you're not done when the timer hits, does the session park and resume tomorrow (carry-forward queue), or block close-of-books until you finish?

Voice or typed

Will you be doing this from the truck (voice friendly) or at a desk (typed)? Changes the prompt design entirely.

WHAT I DO WITH YOUR ANSWERS

Each answer locks one piece of the architecture: Q1 = the schema, Q2 = the join key, Q3 = the tax engine, Q4 = the storage layer and v2 migration path, Q5 = the alerting rules, Q6 = the per-job formula, Q7 = the agent's UX. Once you reply, v1 ships as a single-file agent with the chart of accounts hard-coded, the inventory join wired in, and a 5-minute session that closes the books cleanly enough that v2's automation drops in without rewriting the schema.